Lawrence Lau

Deputy Head of Department & Country Manager · EBC Financial Group

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SUMMARY

Operations leader in financial services with 10 years across back-office, payments, compliance and customer service. As Deputy Head of Department and Country Manager at EBC Financial Group, I lead a 51-person department across eight functions, improving operational efficiency, compliance and team accountability, with measurable gains in workflow systems and customer satisfaction.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Deputy HOD, Country Manager · EBC Financial Group

Aug 2025 – Present

Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia

- **Department Supervision:** Lead and manage operations across multiple departments, ensuring financial strategies are executed smoothly and aligned with company objectives.
- **HR & Administration:** Lead the local entity's HR, L&D and Admin team to foster a positive working environment, structured around the company values of HEART (Honesty, Equity, Appreciation, Respect and Trust).
- **Compliance & Risk Management:** Act as policy maker for all local and departmental standard procedures, ensuring they align with company culture and direction.
- **Cross-Department Coordination:** Direct and motivate cross-functional teams, cultivating a high-performance culture while mentoring team members and developing future leaders.
- **Performance Monitoring:** Oversee day-to-day operations, including budgeting, forecasting and resource allocation, ensuring work is completed on time and within budget.
- **Data & Documentation Management:** Deliver in-depth market analysis and financial reports to upper management to support data-driven decisions.
- **Stakeholder Management:** Collaborate with senior leadership to design and implement strategic initiatives that strengthen the company's competitive position.
- **Reporting & Analysis:** Prepare reports and performance metrics to support management decision-making.
- **Company Directorship:** Ensure compliance with all regulatory requirements; manage corporate governance and oversee legal, financial and compliance matters.
- **Corporate Administration:** Represent the company in external engagements, building positive relationships and reinforcing the corporate brand.
- **Payment Management:** Lead end-to-end payment integration projects, coordinating internal stakeholders, vendors and technical teams through to implementation.
- **Human Resources Planning:** Manage the employee lifecycle, including performance management, disciplinary actions and terminations, in line with company policy and local labour regulations.
- **Office Budgeting:** Own annual budgeting, forecasting and expense planning across operational, administrative and employee-related cost centres.

Teams under supervision (51): Operations 12 · Human Resources 10 · Payments 10 · Product 7 · BI & Data 5 · Anti-Fraud 4 · Office IT 2 · Office Admin 1

Backoffice Team Leader · EBC Financial Group

Apr 2023 – Aug 2025

Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia

- **Team Supervision:** Led and managed the back-office team, ensuring efficient workflow and task execution.
- **Process Optimization:** Developed and implemented standard operating procedures to improve efficiency and accuracy.
- **Compliance & Risk Management:** Ensured adherence to internal policies and external regulations, minimising operational risk.
- **Cross-Department Coordination:** Worked closely with sales, finance and customer service to support overall business functions.
- **Performance Monitoring:** Tracked team performance against KPIs and gave regular feedback for improvement.
- **Training & Development:** Onboarded new team members and provided ongoing training to raise skills and productivity.

- **Data & Documentation Management:** Oversaw data entry, record-keeping and documentation to maintain accuracy and security.
- **Issue Resolution:** Identified and resolved operational challenges promptly to keep the business running smoothly.
- **Reporting & Analysis:** Prepared reports and performance metrics to support management decision-making.

Financial Customer Advisor · Libertex Group
Sep 2020 – Apr 2023

Remote, Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia

- **Risk Assessment & Compliance:** Analysed financial transactions to detect potential fraud, money laundering or regulatory violations.
- **Know Your Customer (KYC):** Conducted thorough client due diligence to verify identities and assess risk profiles.
- **Payment Processing & Monitoring:** Oversaw payment transactions, ensuring smooth processing while identifying suspicious activity.
- **Fraud Prevention & Investigation:** Investigated irregularities, reported potential risks and implemented fraud-prevention measures.
- **Regulatory Adherence:** Ensured compliance with financial regulations and industry standards to mitigate legal risk.
- **Client Advisory & Support:** Advised clients on payment methods, security measures and risk management.
- **Internal Collaboration:** Worked closely with compliance, finance and customer service teams to streamline operations.
- **Reporting & Analysis:** Prepared risk assessment reports and recommended strategies to strengthen financial security.

Senior Customer Service Officer · Bigcat Software Solution
Apr 2016 – Jun 2022

Makati, Philippines

- **Customer Assistance:** Assisted call-in customers with questions and orders, providing timely and accurate support.
- **Product Knowledge & Advisory:** Maintained deep product expertise to give accurate recommendations and resolve issues.
- **Customer Satisfaction & Engagement:** Handled a high daily volume of customers with a positive attitude, raising overall satisfaction.
- **Process Improvement:** Gave constructive feedback to management that contributed to service enhancements.
- **Sales & Cross-Selling:** Introduced products to clients and prospects, identifying opportunities to expand engagement.
- **Account Management:** Maintained an organised system for tracking key account information, speeding up issue resolution.
- **Team Development & Training:** Developed skills-training guidelines that raised customer service standards.

CORE SKILLS

Operations Management · Project Management · Financial Processing · Compliance & Risk Management · Team Leadership & Development · Process Optimization · CRM & Workflow Automation · Customer Service & Retention

AWARDS

- Best Employee of the Year 2025
- Best Employee of the Year 2024
- Best Employee of the Year 2017

LANGUAGES

English · Chinese · Bahasa Malaysia

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Hotel Management
Tunku Abdul Rahman University College